

LIFE IN THE ROMAN EMPIRE

The Roman Empire was a multicultural society, made up of people not just from Europe but also from Africa and the Middle East.

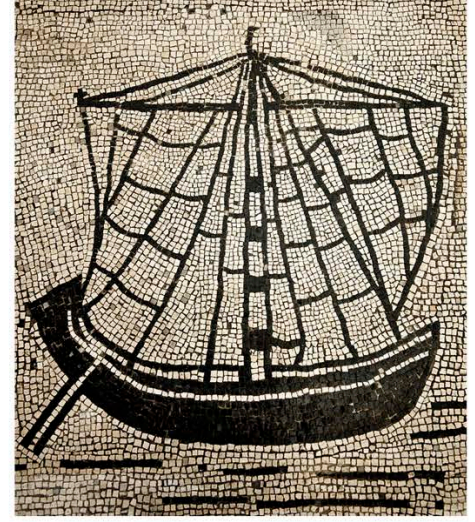
The Romans were innovators, and their technological advances allowed them to improve their quality of life. They built strong roads to connect the empire, and invented concrete, which made their structures last. Many of their buildings even had underfloor heating, which worked by feeding warm air through underground channels.

Culture and literature flourished, too. Ancient Roman writers such as Virgil, Cicero, and Ovid created

some of the most famous texts in history, and are still studied today. Many written records from ancient Rome help us piece together a vivid image of what life was like back then.

FACT

In 79 CE, the volcano Mount Vesuvius erupted, spewing out volcanic lava and ash that destroyed and preserved the Roman towns of Pompeii and Herculaneum. They were rediscovered only in modern times.



▲ FLOURISHING TRADE

Trade was essential to the survival of the empire, particularly the large cities, which needed to import food to feed ever-growing populations. Rome traded via both land and sea. Everyday items such as wine and grain were traded within the empire but many luxury items came from beyond its borders, such as silk from China.

